

Student Resume

Student Name: Ethan Kunder

Unweighted GPA: 4.0

Email: ethan@kunder.cc

LinkedIn: <http://www.linkedin.com/in/ethankunder>

School: Gunderson High School & Silicon Valley Career Technical Education

CURRENT:

Extracurriculars	Awards/Achievements
1. Pursue a lot of interests (coding, music creation, software automation, 3D modeling, 3D printing) 2. Track and field 3. Website building	1. 8 years of RCM music certificates 2. Honor role/superintendent

II. ACADEMIC & CAREER INTERESTS

Intended Major (as of now): Computer Engineering or Mechanical Engineering.

Why this pathway?

My passion for engineering is rooted in a lifelong fascination with how things work. My journey began with low-fidelity engineering—constructing mechanisms out of popsicle sticks, paper, and rubber bands. As I grew, so did the complexity of my projects. I transitioned from simple crafts to 3D modeling, circuit building with microcontrollers, 3D printing custom parts, and integrating complex sensor arrays into fully working products.

I am driven by the process of iteration—taking a concept from a rough sketch to a functional, coded prototype. I want to major in engineering to formalize these skills and apply them to real-world problems.

Top Choice College: Currently, I am keeping my options open. I am researching programs that offer the best balance of rigorous theory and hands-on, project-based learning.

III. CHALLENGES & LEADERSHIP

What obstacles have you overcome in high school?

My biggest challenge and subsequent growth came from trying to build a STEM culture at our school where it was previously lacking.

As a Sophomore, I attempted to launch a Cybersecurity Club. Despite my enthusiasm, I struggled to gain traction and only recruited two members. I eventually had to dissolve the club, which was a difficult lesson in the realities of leadership and engagement. However, I didn't let that failure stop my goal of increasing STEM accessibility.

I pivoted my energy into helping co-found the school's Robotics Team. It was a slow start with only four members, but I applied the lessons learned from my previous attempt to build a stronger foundation. Now, as a Junior and the Club President, I have successfully doubled our membership to eight active participants. We are currently working diligently to prepare for the First Tech Challenge (FTC) this February. Leading this team has taught me that failure is just a data point for future success.

IV. CHARACTER & WORK ETHIC

Key Personality Traits:

Problem Solver: I do not give up easily. If I encounter a gap in my knowledge, I take the initiative to self-teach the necessary concepts to complete the task. I view confusion as an invitation to learn, not a reason to stop.

Reliable & Trustworthy: I pride myself on my integrity. Peers and adults know that if I commit to a project or a deadline, I will deliver quality work.

Intellectually Curious: I have a genuine "thirst for knowledge." Whether it is coding, mechanics, or music, I am constantly exploring new disciplines to broaden my understanding of the world. I am always willing to learn, even if it is outside my comfort zone, and challenges don't scare me.

V. BEYOND THE CLASSROOM

What is something your teacher probably doesn't know about you?

While my academic focus is engineering, I have a strong entrepreneurial spirit and a creative side.

Ed-Tech Entrepreneurship: I am currently developing an online platform designed to bridge the educational gap between districts. The goal is to connect students, teachers, and mentors, allowing students in under-resourced areas to access valuable insights and tips from staff in other districts.

Musician: I have been a lifelong musician, starting with piano and moving to drums. I actively serve on my church's worship team and enjoy composing my own music at home.

Community service: till two years ago, I regularly volunteered in the 4-year-olds' Sunday school at my church, supporting their early childhood learning and care, and I have also helped build transitional housing for single and abused mothers and their children through CityTeam.